

Pikachu Plush Completes 67-Day Space Station Visit

From: DOGOnews Mined: 2026-10-03 5 min read

The European Space Agency (ESA) **revealed** on September 19, 2026, that a special Pikachu plush had spent 67 days on the International Space Station (ISS). The toy went to the ISS on a Cygnus cargo spacecraft on April 11. It returned to Earth on June 17 aboard a SpaceX Dragon cargo spacecraft. During its time in **orbit**, Pikachu completed about 1,040 trips around Earth.

The mission was part of ESA's plans to celebrate World Space Week 2026, which will be held from October 4 through 10. To mark the occasion, ESA has created a special **exhibit** that combines real space science with Pokémon characters. It includes themed displays of Europe's space missions and life aboard the ISS. Visitors can also explore how ESA studies the Sun, the Solar System, and the wider universe.

The **exhibit** tour began at ESA headquarters in Paris, France, in late September. It will then travel to museums and other **venues** across Europe through April 2027.

Fans of the Pokémon GO game will also be able to join the space-themed activities. From October 4, 2026, through April 30, 2027, players visiting participating science and space museums across Europe can take part. Activities include One-Star Raids featuring Astronaut Pikachu and research tasks. There will also be chances to **encounter** event-themed Pokémon.

ESA hopes the project will spark **curiosity** about space and science in children and teens. "Inspiring future generations is a key part of ESA's mission," said Josef Aschbacher, the Director General of ESA.

Word Treasure

revealed -- Made information known.

orbit -- A path around an object in space.

exhibit -- A collection of displays for visitors to explore.

venues -- Places where events or activities happen.

encounter -- Come across or meet.

curiosity -- A desire to learn or find out more.

Break it down

Reports ESA's announcement and the plush's space station visit.

Links the visit to World Space Week and describes the science exhibit.

Explains where the exhibit tour began and how long it will travel.

Lists the dates, locations, and types of Pokémon GO activities.

Closes with ESA's educational goal and an attributed statement.

Why it matters

ESA's project gives museum visitors a way to explore space science through Pokémon-themed displays and activities. Its stated goal is to spark scientific curiosity in children and teens.

Test what you remember

1. About how many trips around Earth did Pikachu complete?
 - (A) About 140 trips
 - (B) About 4,010 trips
 - (C) About 1,040 trips
 - (D) About 670 trips
2. Which spacecraft carried Pikachu to the ISS?
 - (A) A space science research spacecraft
 - (B) A space station crew capsule
 - (C) A Cygnus cargo spacecraft
 - (D) A SpaceX Dragon cargo spacecraft
3. When will World Space Week 2026 take place?
 - (A) November 4 through 10
 - (B) December 4 through 10
 - (C) October 4 through 10
 - (D) September 4 through 10
4. What do the exhibit's themed displays include?
 - (A) Europe's railway journeys and life aboard trains
 - (B) Europe's space missions and life aboard the ISS
 - (C) Europe's ocean missions and life aboard ships
 - (D) Europe's mountain expeditions and life at camps
5. When do the special Pokémon GO museum activities end?
 - (A) October 30, 2027
 - (B) June 30, 2027
 - (C) April 30, 2027
 - (D) August 30, 2027
6. What did Josef Aschbacher describe as a key part of ESA's mission?
 - (A) Organizing more research tasks
 - (B) Inspiring future generations
 - (C) Expanding the museum tour
 - (D) Developing new game characters

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: C 4: B 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Josef Aschbacher: He said that inspiring future generations is a key part of ESA's mission.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):